



SMBA Draft RFP Amendment 13 Industry Day

September 2025



Implementation Phase Draft RFP Overview

Welcome

- Thank you all for your feedback!
 - The SMBA documentation has seen significant change since the initial Draft RFP release
- We are using today to
 - Elaborate on the thinking behind the documents that were released with the SMBA Implementation Phase Draft Request for Proposal (RFP)
 - Point towards areas of interest for feedback
 - Answer questions Industry Partners might have
 - Foster discussion on the SMBA instrument, selections, and contract

The SMBA Implementation Phase Statement of Work (SOW), Contract Data Requirements List (CDRL), Performance Requirements Document (PRD), Evaluation Criteria for Phase I, Evaluation Criteria for Phase II, sample contract, and other information included in the Draft RFP are available on SAM.gov at the following link: <https://sam.gov/opp/735ebcc771da41568f96d4163708e663/view>

Anything in the final SMBA Implementation Phase Request for Proposal (RFP) will supersede the information provided as part of this overview.

- The NEON team will continue to conduct one on ones with Industry Partners as requested
- Salient information will be provided to all Industry Partners
 - Questions will be posted anonymously
- The final chart deck from today will be posted on SAM.gov

- Draft RFP Responses Due – October 6, 2025
- One on Ones – Ongoing until RFP release
- RFP Release – End of Q1 CY 2026
- Phase 1 Award – Q2 CY 2027
- Phase 2 RFP Release – CY 2028
 - Phase 1 Award plus approximately 18 months

The Government intends to prioritize performance over process in accordance with the following risk posture:

*The SMBA Instrument maintains **lower-risk tolerance** for delivering heritage-equivalent (including ATMS, TROPICS, and MWS) performance and microwave sounding data continuity, for delivering hyperspectral, RFI detection and intercalibration capabilities, for compliance with science performance requirements as specified in the PRD, and for adherence to safety standards. The SMBA instrument maintains **higher-risk tolerance** for adopting non-Government processes and standards that do not negatively impact areas of lower-risk tolerance to achieve cost-effective mission success. Where these areas conflict, achieving SMBA performance is most critical.*

This risk posture should be used for guidance in making risk-informed decisions.

- Will award up to two contracts, each having two phases with the intent to down-select to one contract after Phase 1
 - Phase 1: Design through Engineering Test Unit (ETU) Completion – Cost Plus
 - Long Lead Items for FM1 through FM4 – Fixed Price
 - Phase 2: Production of Flight Model (FM)1 through FM8
 - Base Contract: Production of FM1 through FM4 – Fixed Price
 - Option 1: FM5 through FM8 all together
 - Production of FM5 through FM8 – Fixed Price
- Proposals will cover both phases, initial contract is only through Phase 1
 - See sections L and M for further information
- Contract includes requirements for both phases
 - SoW, CDRL, PRD are for both phases

- Allowed deliverables in Industry formats
- Required Government “participation” on anomaly review boards
- Reduced inspection points
- Reduced requests for plans
- Required fewer analyses
- Statement of Work and Deliverables cut by ~50%
- Full flight qualified ETU remains
- Relying on formal reviews and testing to provide performance

Trusting Industry has the Knowledge and Processes for Producing Flight Hardware

- Instrument Mission Assurance Requirements have been reduced and incorporated into the SoW
 - Retained launch site required documents
 - Retained final instrument description documents
- Will rely more on Industry Partner standard Mission Assurance processes

- Technical specifications are mature and close to their final RFP state
 - Some adjustments made to specifications after draft RFP given feedback
 - No changes planned for frequency band, heritage channel, hyperspectral & RFI detection band requirements
- Changes include
 - New Spacecraft-to-Instrument command & data transfer interface requirement for space-based Ethernet
 - Requirements clarification
 - Document cleanup
- The PRD intentionally leaves some items up to the proposer with some guidelines including these examples (not necessarily a complete list):
 - Frequency band start & stop
 - Channel set to downlink
 - RFI detection ConOps
 - Thermal design & test ranges
 - Instrument on-board storage
 - Spacecraft-to-Instrument interfaces
 - Requirements with TBS

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Feedback Continues to be Welcome Until Blackout at RFP Release!

Questions?

A stylized world map composed of glowing blue dots and connecting lines, set against a dark blue background. The map is centered on the Atlantic Ocean, with the continents of North and South America visible on the left and Europe and Africa on the right. The dots are of varying sizes and are connected by thin, light blue lines, creating a network-like structure. The overall aesthetic is futuristic and digital.